

// THE NIGHT SHIFT

It crashed only on cheap phones

Our service died for thousands
of users.

The stack trace blamed a line
that does nothing wrong.

// THE PROMISE

5 seconds to keep your word

Start a foreground service and
you promise a notification.

The system gives you ~5s to
call `startForeground()`.

Miss it and it kills you.

// THE TRAP

Slow work before the promise

disk reads, db, init...
then startForeground().
80ms on your phone.
5 seconds on a cold, cheap
device under load. Crash.

// FIX 01

Notify first

Call `startForeground()` on the first line, minimal notification.

Do the slow work after.

Update the notification once you have real content.

Android 12: use WorkManager

You often cannot start an FGS from the background at all. Use WorkManager with an expedited request instead. Let the system schedule it.

Doze is the night jailer

You get 5 seconds to explain
why your work belongs.
The platform protects the
user's battery, not attacks you.
Explain fast.

// THE TAKEAWAY

Work with the lifecycle

Post the notification first.

Respect the background limits.

Then the system leaves your
work alone.